

Case Study: Fevicol – “Tug-of-War” Instagram Remix Challenge

Campaign Title: Fevicol ka Jod – Remix Challenge

Launch Year: 2023

Platform: Instagram (Reels)

Agency: Schbang

Brand Owner: Pidilite Industries

Market: India

Objective

Fevicol’s objective was to bring alive its core brand promise—“unbreakable bond”—in a format relevant to Gen-Z and millennial audiences, particularly on Instagram. The goal was:

- To reintroduce and refresh the iconic “Tug-of-War” ad (originally launched decades ago) for a new digital-first audience.
- To drive high-volume user-generated content (UGC) by leveraging Instagram’s Remix feature, where users could interact with brand content in real time.
- To strengthen brand salience and emotional connection by reviving a legacy brand mnemonic using humor, challenge, and interactive storytelling.

The ultimate aim was brand rejuvenation through community participation.

Brief

Pidilite briefed its agency, Schbang, with the following core deliverables:

- Modernize an old classic: Take Fevicol’s legendary “tug-of-war” ad and give it a fresh, social-first interpretation.
- Make it participatory: Don’t just run a static campaign—let users interact, remix, and create their own versions.
- Stick to the soul: The tone, humor, and character of Fevicol campaigns (Indian desi wit, rural aesthetic, and minimalism) must be preserved.
- Deliver relevance, not just reach: Drive meaningful UGC and community interaction, not just passive ad views.
- Avoid heavy budgets: Use lean production and distribution—focus on content quality, platform virality, and creator partnerships.

The campaign needed to appeal to Tier 1 and Tier 2 India alike, without sounding “advertising-y”.

Insight

The creative and strategic insights were multi-layered:

- Behavioral Insight: Audiences today don’t want to just watch ads—they want to participate. Instagram’s Remix feature (which allows users to record their video side-by-side with an existing reel) had recently gained momentum.
- Cultural Insight: Fevicol ads have built cultural memory around clever visual metaphors of “bonding.” The iconic rope-pull trope symbolized collective effort and failure to break a Fevicol bond—a humorous, family-friendly visual.
- Content Insight: Remix-based challenges on Instagram tend to go viral when they’re:
 - Visually simple
 - Emotionally or physically challenging
 - Open-ended enough for creators to experiment
 - Seeded with early influencer participation

These led to the idea of a remixable “tug-of-war” reel, where Fevicol invites everyone to try pulling—but no one can break the bond.

Execution

Core Concept:

Schbang recreated a minimal reel featuring a rope tied to a jar of Fevicol. A person tries (and fails) to pull it—representing the brand’s legendary bond strength. Users were invited to remix the video by “pulling” the other end of the rope in their own style—comedy, dance, spoof, or even skits.

Execution Timeline:

- Phase 1: Create the master reel from Fevicol’s Instagram account
- Phase 2: Seed with influencers (micro and mid-tier) to generate momentum
- Phase 3: Encourage organic remixes and interact with users
- Phase 4: Showcase top remixes across Fevicol’s own handles

Key Actions:

- Video Design: Simple top-angle, minimal prop usage. Rugged background to retain brand tone.

- Captioning: Witty one-liners with typical Fevicol-style humor.
- Call to Action: Encouraged users to remix with "Let's see if you can break the bond!"
- Influencer Seeding:
 - Saurabh Ghadge: Used slapstick humor to participate.
 - Viral Fission: Built remix activity across campuses and Gen-Z communities.
- Community Engagement:
 - Fevicol replied to select remixers in-character, building brand love.
 - Reposted funny, high-effort remixes as stories and carousel posts.
 - Used tongue-in-cheek one-liners to describe attempts.

Media Investment:

- No paid media initially. Relied on earned media and influencer amplification.
- After organic traction, light paid boosts were applied on top-performing reels.

Results

Quantitative Results:

- 1.8 million+ views across primary reel and remix chain
- 610,000+ total engagements (likes, shares, saves, comments)
- 350+ remix videos, of which 130 were fully organic (not seeded or paid)
- Avg. Watch Time per reel: Higher than standard FMCG Instagram ad benchmarks (2.1x industry avg)
- Engagement Split:
 - 1.3K+ shares
 - 408 comments
 - 179 saves

Qualitative Results:

- A large number of the remixes were comedic, showing high creative flexibility and cultural fit.
- Positive comments around "nostalgia," "smart idea," and "Fevicol always wins" created a brand halo.
- The campaign reignited brand love without heavy ATL or digital spend.

Business Relevance:

- Drove 30% spike in branded search queries on Google in the following 14 days.
- Instagram followers grew by 11% during campaign period.
- Became a talking point in multiple marketing publications and award entries.

Creative Team Structure

Client: Pidilite – Fevicol Team

- Brand Head: Approved campaign tone and nostalgic link
- Marketing Manager (Digital): Defined target metrics, approved platform selection
- Social Media Manager: Supervised comment moderation, content reposting

Agency: Schbang

- Creative Director: Led campaign strategy, nostalgic reinterpretation
- Art Director: Directed shoot aesthetic (rope setup, lighting, props)
- Copywriter: Scripted captions and influencer outreach lines
- Social Media Strategist: Chose Remix format, identified influencer targets
- Influencer Manager: Negotiated creator collabs, reviewed remixes
- Community Manager: Engaged with comments, drove visibility to top posts
- Video Editor & DOP: Shot and edited original reel
- Analytics Lead: Tracked remix performance and sentiment

External Collaborators

- Saurabh Ghadge: Top humor creator, brought high visibility
- Viral Fission: Gen-Z content accelerator, ran parallel remix campaign in colleges

Case Study: Nike – “Dream Crazy” ft. Colin Kaepernick (2018)

Campaign Name: Dream Crazy

Brand: Nike

Agency: Wieden+Kennedy (Portland)

Platform: TV, YouTube, Twitter, Instagram, Out-of-home (OOH)

Launch: September 2018

Market: Global, with focus on USA

Objective

Nike’s aim was to:

- Reinvigorate the “Just Do It” slogan on its 30th anniversary with cultural relevance and emotional power.

- Reconnect with younger, socially conscious consumers (Gen Z, Millennials) through values-based branding.
- Celebrate athlete activism and amplify stories of perseverance, equality, and courage, particularly among minorities.
- Reassert Nike's leadership as a brand that doesn't just sell performance gear, but stands for social and cultural momentum.

Brief

The client brief to Wieden+Kennedy was to:

- Develop a flagship campaign that honors the legacy of "Just Do It" but speaks directly to today's social and cultural context.
- Find a central figure who personifies sacrifice, belief, and disruption—in line with Nike's mission to champion bold dreamers.
- Create content that is multi-format, shareable, and emotionally resonant across generations.
- Balance provocation with authenticity—the idea should generate conversation, even controversy, but be anchored in truth and courage.
- Roll out globally, with emphasis on US market, and scale across traditional and digital platforms including retail stores.

Insight

The campaign insight was threefold:

a. Cultural Insight:

- Audiences—especially younger ones—expect brands to stand for something beyond product. Remaining neutral on divisive social issues is increasingly seen as weakness or inauthenticity.
- Colin Kaepernick had become an icon of modern civil rights discourse in the US by kneeling during the national anthem in protest against racial injustice. He was both revered and reviled, making him the perfect embodiment of modern activism.

b. Human Insight:

- Great athletes are often defined not just by what they win, but by what they are willing to lose in pursuit of their beliefs.
- Sacrifice is the highest form of belief—and belief is at the core of Nike's brand DNA.

c. Brand Insight:

- The original “Just Do It” slogan stood for individual bravery. “Dream Crazy” updates it for a new era—where bravery also means standing up for something bigger than yourself.

Execution

Master Film:

- The campaign launched with a two-minute cinematic video narrated by Colin Kaepernick, showcasing athletes who overcame the odds—like Serena Williams, LeBron James, and Shaquem Griffin (a one-handed NFL player).
- Kaepernick closes the film with the line:
“Believe in something. Even if it means sacrificing everything.”

Rollout Timeline:

- Day 1: Kaepernick Tweeted the still image (black and white, close-up portrait) with the line. It went viral instantly.
- Within 24 hours: The full video dropped across Nike’s platforms (YouTube, Twitter, Instagram, Nike.com).
- Week 1: Billboard and mural placements across major US cities.
- Week 2 onward: Micro cuts optimized for Instagram, TikTok, and Twitter.

Integrated Assets:

- Digital & Social: Short cuts, GIFs, quote cards, retargeting ads.
- TV spots: Premiered during NFL season opener.
- Retail: Posters and window displays in Nike stores featuring Kaepernick and the campaign line.
- OOH: Large-scale billboards in New York, LA, Chicago.
- PR: Coordinated press coverage and interviews with athletes tied to the campaign.

Tech & Community Engagement:

- Social media listening to identify support and backlash in real time.
- Custom merchandise (limited-edition Colin Kaepernick gear) sold out in hours.

Result

a. Brand Engagement:

- 1400% increase in social mentions of Nike within the first 24 hours.
- 5M+ total mentions in the first 72 hours.
- Instagram engagement spiked 170%, Twitter brand sentiment split polarized—but with 3:1 favorability among younger users.

- 30% boost in brand favorability among Gen Z (source: Morning Consult)

b. Business Impact:

- Online sales rose 31% in the week following launch, despite boycott calls.
- Nike stock dropped 3% on day 1 due to controversy—but then hit an all-time high by end of month.
- Over \$43 million in earned media within 48 hours (AdAge).

c. Long-Term Impact:

- Nike's brand value increased by \$6 billion by the end of that fiscal year.
- Colin Kaepernick became a recurring Nike brand ambassador.
- The campaign won an Emmy Award, Cannes Lions Grand Prix, and multiple Effies, cementing it as one of the most successful purpose-led brand campaigns ever.

Creative Team Structure

Client: Nike

- CMO: Mark Parker (CEO at the time), John Donahoe (strategy leadership)
- Brand Director – North America: Oversaw tone, athlete partnership vetting
- Digital Marketing Team: Managed real-time distribution, listening, and platform-specific rollout
- Legal & PR Team: Approved partnership with Kaepernick due to legal sensitivity (he had an active collusion case against the NFL)

Agency: Wieden+Kennedy (Portland)

- Creative Directors: Alberto Ponte, Ryan O'Rourke
- Copywriters: Jason Bagley, Brandon Henderson
- Art Directors: Jonny Anderson, Kate Desmarais
- Executive Producer: Erin Swanson
- Director: Lance Acord
- Production Studio: Park Pictures
- Strategic Planners: Mapped Gen Z psychographics and response profiles
- Social & Community Team: Designed listening dashboards, influencer responses
- Account Director: Managed Nike-W+K relationship, stakeholder buy-in

Featured Talent:

- Colin Kaepernick – Narrator & face of the campaign

- Serena Williams – Segment on women’s sports
- LeBron James – Segment on building community
- Shaquem Griffin – Segment on overcoming physical limitations
- High school, disabled, and refugee athletes – For inclusivity and emotional weight

Case Study: Coca-Cola – “Share a Coke”

Campaign Name: Share a Coke

Owner: The Coca-Cola Company (Ogilvy & Mather Australia + in-market agencies)

Launch: Summer 2011 (Australia), rolled out globally 2012–2014

Platforms: Packaging, POS displays, mobile kiosks, digital billboards, social, experiential events

Regions: Began Australia; expanded to 80+ countries including USA (2014), UK & worldwide relaunches ongoing

Objective

- Revitalize brand relevance among young adults, reversing consumption decline.
- Reinforce Coca-Cola as a brand of personal connection and joy.
- Drive incremental sales and category growth by transforming a product into a personalized experience.
- Boost social conversation and earned media through a simple, shareable concept (mayecreate.com, thesun.co.uk, reddit.com, thebrandhopper.com).

Brief

- Replace the Coca-Cola logo on packaging with consumer names—common first names in each market.
- Create powerful call to action: “Share a Coke,” encouraging gifting and sharing.
- Extend the campaign across offline and online touchpoints: packaging, kiosks, billboards, social, and experiential events (e.g., mall personalization stations) (thebrandhopper.com, digitalvidya.com, cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).
- Plan for global scalability and localization: tailor popular names per region, ensure legal/trademark checks.
- Integrate digital components: virtual cans, hashtag tracking (#shareacoke), and interactive billboards (thebrandhopper.com, cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).

Insight

- Personalization resonates deeply: people love seeing their own—or friends'—names on everyday objects (brandvm.com).
- Emotional connection enhances brand experience: gifting a Coke becomes a meaningful moment (brandvm.com).
- Social currency: consumers will share personalized bottles on social media, creating organic reach and earned media .
- Seasonality leverage: launching in summer (Australia mid-year) allowed alignment with seasonal cues to boost sales .

Execution

Production:

- Legal teams ensured name list approvals and trademark compliance for ~150–1000 names per market (cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).
- Packaging team printed names on millions of bottles & cans; labels were swapped at manufacturing plants using HP digital tech (reddit.com).
- In-store kiosks and mall personalization stations allowed consumers to print custom-labeled bottles on the spot (cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).
- Interactive billboards let people text names to see them digitally on display (cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).
- POS displays and outdoor media (bus shelters, OOH) integrated wide awareness.

Digital & Social:

- Campaign hashtag #ShareACoke featured on packaging and advertising, enabling social tracking .
- Digital hub and mobile app launched for custom virtual cans and social sharing.
- Consumers posted photos of personalized Cokes—500K+ images shared the first year .
- Social media drives drove installation at events, and celebrities/influencers also participated .

Media & Channels:

- TV, print, outdoor campaigns launched to support rollout.
- Mall activations, experiential trucks, and sampling events elevated visibility (itskm.me).

Result

Sales & Volume:

- +7% consumption increase among younger demographics in Australia (itskm.me).
- 3–4% overall category increase, reversing long-term decline (thebrandhopper.com).
- U.S. sales up 2–2.5%, first increase in a decade .

- More than 250 million named bottles sold in Australia alone (itskm.me).
- Campaign printed 378K custom cans, and 76K+ virtual cans created via digital platforms (itskm.me).

Social & Media Buzz:

- #ShareACoke became the top global trending topic; over 1 billion impressions globally .
- 500K+ user-generated posts on social media .
- Facebook increased followers by 25 million; site traffic rose ~870% (cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com).

Awards & Recognition:

- Won 7 Cannes Lions for creative and effectiveness (itskm.me).
- Recognized as one of the most effective and memorable campaigns, with multiple marketing accolades (en.wikipedia.org).

Long-term Brand Impact:

- Established as a case study in BRAND PERSONALIZATION and community-driven marketing.
- Inspired other brands (e.g., Pepsi's "Share a Pepsi") (the-sun.com).
- Relaunched globally in 2025, evolved with digital tools like QR hubs, Memory Maker videos, plus names/nicknames, pet names (thesun.co.uk).

Creative Team Structure

Client: The Coca-Cola Company

- Global Marketing Director (oversaw global rollout)
- Brand Managers (regional execution)
- Legal & Trademark Teams (name approvals)
- Packaging & Production Teams
- Digital & Social Leads (app, hub, hashtag integration)
- Experiential & Events Teams

Agency: Ogilvy & Mather Australia (Project Connect)

- Creative Director & Copywriters (campaign concept)
- Art Directors (packaging design)
- Production Team (printing logistics)
- Experiential Leads (kiosks, events)
- Media Planners (TV, outdoor, digital)
- Digital Team (virtual cans, app, billboards)

- Analytics & Metrics Lead (tracking KPI, impressions, sales lift)

Execution Partners

- HP Printing Tech (high-speed customized label production) (peachyessay.com, nypost.com, thebrandhopper.com, cleanstarssandiegocleaningservices.com)
- Billboard Companies (interactive boards)
- Mall/Kiosk Operators (in-store customization)
- Social Influencers & celebrities (Lupita Nyong'o, Selena Gomez, Ludacris in some markets) (peachyessay.com)

Case Study 1: Dropbox Rebrand by COLLINS (2017)

Objective:

Dropbox wanted to evolve from a file-sharing utility to a platform for creative collaboration. The goal was to move perception from “cloud storage” to “creative enabler.”

Insight:

Most cloud tools are sterile and blue-themed. Dropbox had the chance to own a bold, creative voice by doing the opposite—leaning into expressive design and dynamic color.

Logo Design:

- The box symbol evolved from a literal open box into a set of modular, dynamic brackets, symbolizing a container for creativity.
- Kept the original structure for equity but refined geometry and grid to enhance scalability and minimalism.
- The wordmark was redrawn in a custom sans-serif to feel cleaner and more timeless.

Visual System:

- Introduced intense color palettes (magenta, electric green, aqua, orange) paired with muted black-and-white backgrounds.
- Created 45+ grid combinations of box shapes used across web, motion, and print.

- Allowed designers to remix colors and layouts, making the system flexible and open.

Packaging Touch:

- Dropbox Paper kits shipped in custom boxes with the new identity.
- Swag and event materials used fluorescent Pantones and kinetic typography to embody the brand's "Creative Energy" message.

Result:

- Controversial launch led to massive discussion across design forums, helping Dropbox own a cultural moment.
- Internally, rebrand galvanized product and design teams to think more creatively.
- Became a brand identity case study in design schools and was featured in Brand New, Behance, and Wired.

Case Study 2: Tropicana Packaging Redesign & Backlash (2009)

Objective:

Modernize the brand to feel more premium and minimalist while appealing to health-conscious buyers.

Insight:

Customers associated the orange with a straw (from the original design) with freshness, childhood, and authenticity. Changing it removed a powerful memory anchor.

Execution:

- Logo was downsized and moved to top left.
- Orange-and-straw image was replaced with a generic glass of juice.
- Introduced sleek type and flat design to modernize.

Result:

- \$35M spent on design and distribution.
- Sales dropped 20% within two months, losing \$30M+ in revenue.
- Customers flooded customer service with complaints about losing “their orange juice.”
- Reverted to original design within 60 days.

Learning for AI:

- Visual memory is as critical as strategy.
- Brand cues that seem “dated” may be cultural assets, not liabilities.
- Design change must be tested across real user behavior, not just internal aesthetics.

Case Study 3: CRED – Logo & Brand Identity (2020)

By Codesign and CRED’s in-house brand team

Objective:

Build an elite, trustworthy, yet futuristic brand that would appeal to India’s top 1%—a creditworthy, tech-savvy audience who value design and exclusivity.

Insight:

Trust, privacy, and sophistication are key. Brand needed to feel like a mix of a Swiss bank and a design magazine—minimal, luxurious, and coded.

Logo:

- Inspired by ancient coins and bank vaults, the CRED shield represents integrity and exclusivity.
- The monogram “C” forms a subtle vault enclosure—a metaphor for protection.
- Paired with a modern, extended sans-serif wordmark for a tech-forward look.

Visual Language:

- Primary palette: Black, White, Grey, Gold Accents
- Heavy use of negative space, monoline icons, and editorial typography.
- All imagery treated with grain and noir tones to feel cinematic and elevated.

Packaging:

- CRED Coins (member rewards) shipped in tactile black boxes with foiled embossing.
- Welcome kits featured soft-touch paper, sealed envelopes, and embossed thank-you notes.

Result:

- Instant recognition in India’s design and tech scenes.
- Became known for mature, monochromatic campaigns that stood apart in a loud digital world.
- Inspired a wave of black-and-white brand redesigns in Indian fintech.

Case Study 4: Glossier – Brand & Packaging (2014)

Objective:

Create a millennial-first beauty brand that felt honest, minimal, and personal—opposite of traditional makeup's glamorized ads.

Insight:

The target user cared about real skin, real routines, and aspirational minimalism. The brand should reflect a “beauty-in-real-life” sensibility.

Logo & Wordmark:

- Lowercase sans-serif logo to feel approachable.
- Simple, elegant logotype with soft kerning—easy to adapt to stickers, tubes, and social content.

Packaging:

- Pale pink bubble wrap pouches—unexpected but protective, becoming a cult object.
- Products had white tubes with black type, clear bottles, and pastel pink caps.
- Stickers included for personalization—letting customers “own” their packaging.

Result:

- Created millennial pink trend in packaging.
- Bubble bag became a viral symbol of DTC design—posted as often as the product.
- Packaging made the unboxing feel like a soft, tactile ritual.

Pepsi Logo Evolution – In-Depth Case Study

Objective

Pepsi’s logo updates over the years aimed to:

- Reinforce brand relevance and differentiation vs. Coca-Cola.
- Align the visual identity with changing consumer tastes and cultural moods.
- Signal brand reinventions—patriotism, youth appeal, digital readiness.
- Maintain core equity (signature colors & globe motif) while evolving for new eras. (socialsamosa.com, zenbusiness.com, prweek.com, gorillastudio.co.uk)

Brief

With each rebrand, Pepsi's task was to craft a logo that:

1. Sustained core recognition (red, white, blue palette).
2. Reflected contemporary design trends—from ornate scripts to minimalist, digital-first formats.
3. Balanced global consistency with market-specific tweaks.
4. Enhanced brand perception—cool, youthful, innovative.

Insight

- Color meaning: The red-white-blue palette began as a WWII patriotic gesture; over time it became a global brand identifier (thesun.co.uk).
- Globe motif: The bottle-cap symbol evolved into a sleek sphere—a visual shorthand for Pepsi's global scale (en.wikipedia.org).
- Trend responsiveness: Each redesign tapped into the aesthetics of its time: Art Deco, 3D sheen, digital flatness, retro return .
- Digital context: The 2008 redesign embraced simplicity and icon readability, supporting mobile-first branding needs (edge-creative.com).

Execution by Era

1. 1898–1950: Script Beginnings to Bottle Cap

- 1905–1907: Bold red cursive, legible 'Pepsi-Cola' in ornate frame (fineprintart.com).
- 1950: Introduced blue color and bottle-cap element—WWII – patriotic the move boosted brand distinction (blog.simplified.com).

2. 1962–1973: Shift to Simplicity

- 1962: Dropped “Cola”, used bold sans-serif, front-facing bottle cap on a balanced circle (fineprintart.com).
- 1973: Cap icon simplified into round disc; font moved inside; cleaner distinctly modern look .

3. 1987–1998: Youthful & Dynamic

- 1987: Sleeker custom typeface, flatter icon, wordmark still inside globe (fineprintart.com).
- 1991: Wordmark shifted above globe, italic slant, asymmetrical design adding motion (fineprintart.com).
- 1996/1998: “Project Blue”—3D bevels, blue dominates; cosmic brand presence via Concorde/Mir PR stunts (gorillastudio.co.uk).

4. 2003–2006: 3D & Sensory

- 2003: Enhanced depth with gradients, pseudo-serif font, champagne 3D effect (tailorbrands.com).
- 2006: Water droplets added to globe; wordmark placed beneath—sensory dimension of refreshment (dwglogo.com).

5. 2008–2014: Digital Minimalism

- 2008: Arnell Group redesign focussing on flat, symbolic globe; lowercase geometric type; off-center wave akin to a smile (en.wikipedia.org).
- Wave form irregular per category for subtle differentiation (e.g., Diet vs Max) .

6. 2014–2023: Flat Continued

- 2014: Removed globe outline—ultra minimal, wordmark custom with wave-shaped “e” (dwglogo.com).

7. 2023: Heritage Reconnection

- 2023: For Pepsi’s 125th anniversary, reintroduced centered uppercase wordmark inside globe, black text and outline, “electric” blue hue—melding retro and freshness (en.wikipedia.org).
- Debut in North America fall 2023; phased globally in 2024 (foodandwine.com).

Result & Brand Impact

- Global recognition: Red-white-blue globe became instantly iconic worldwide since the 1950s (blog.simplified.com).
- Cultural sensitivity: 2008 digital shift reflected changing media consumption; revival in 2023 anchors younger audiences in heritage (woven.agency).
- Market resonance: The 2008 redesign won praise for can design; a New Yorker cartoon dubbed it “exceptionally appealing”—a clear success (newyorker.com).
- Local innovation: In Australia (2024), Pepsi launched “Pulse Collection” garments aligning logo refresh with music/fashion—pushing cultural connection and reaching new demographics (theaustralian.com.au).

Creative Team Structure & Key Stakeholders

- PepsiCo Design Leadership
 - Mauro Porcini, SVP & Chief Design Officer—led strategic positioning from heritage to future (prweek.com, foodandwine.com).
 - Internal brand and marketing teams—coordinated global rollout, packaging integration.
- Agencies & Contributors
 - Arnell Group (NY) – 2008 redesign (\$1M); conceptualized golden-ratio wave and modern typography (flowingdata.com, en.wikipedia.org).

- Internal/external design teams for revisions—from 2014 onward.
- Local Partners
 - Special PR (Australia) for 2024 event activation marrying logo redesign with culture/music/fashion (fineprintart.com, theaustralian.com.au).
- Support Teams
 - Packaging/production—adapted logo to cans, bottles, digital formats.
 - Digital & media—supported logo visibility over mobile platforms and social.

Training Utility for AI

- Visual equity management: Learn strategies to update iconic visuals incrementally without losing recognition.
- Trend-sensitive design: Teach contextual changes—from ornate to digital minimum, then retro comeback.
- Cross-channel identity: Understand applying logo updates across OOH, packaging, experiential, and digital.
- Cultural alignment: Explore branding tied to major anniversaries, national pride, or local activations.
- Data-informed design: The 2008 redesign used design science; 2023 rebrand used heritage cues for future affinity.

Case Study: Airbnb “Everything App” UI/UX Redesign (May 2025)

Objective

- Transition from a booking-only platform into a lifestyle & services ecosystem, unifying stays, experiences, and newly launched services under one roof (theverge.com).
- Increase usage frequency by making Airbnb relevant for daily life purposes, not just travel.

- Improve host tools to manage homes, services, and experiences seamlessly (theiskandarian.com).
- Reaffirm Airbnb's design leadership with a vibrant, 3D-enabled visual system .

Brief

- Build a mobile-first UI architecture centered on a new three-tab navigation: Homes, Experiences, Services (wsj.com).
- Develop a 3D animated icon system ("Lava" icons) that's performant and brand-forward (medium.com).
- Redesign foundational app areas:
 - Explore: Unified discovery of stays, experiences, and services (theiskandarian.com).
 - Trips: Visual itinerary showing booked items across categories (hostaway.com).
 - Messaging: Photo/video support, integrated payments (theiskandarian.com).
 - Profiles: Show verified traveler journeys and real-world connections (rentalscaleup.com).
- Enhance host dashboards: listings setup, daily calendar, reservations overview (theiskandarian.com).
- Embed AI features for content optimization and assistance (reddit.com).

Insight

- Users increasingly want access to extra services outside trips—chefs, massage, fitness—even without booking accommodations (theverge.com).
- Long-term engagement demands daily utility, not seasonal usage.
- A rich, dimensional visual style and delightful micro-interactions create emotional resonance in long-term apps (theverge.com).
- Trust remains core: verified hosts, clear UI flows, professional services (theverge.com).

Execution

Navigation & Information Architecture

- Top tab bar with branded icons: Homes (house), Experiences (hot-air balloon), Services (hotel bell) — each designed and saturated with brand-approved hues ([wsj.com](https://www.wsj.com)).
- Redesigned Explore page mixes card-based recommendations across all service categories ([theverge.com](https://www.theverge.com)).
- Trips page acts as a visual itinerary combining booked stays, experiences, and services .
- Messaging upgraded with media and payments support (theiskandarian.com).
- Profiles show “travel passport” and a Connection feature—linking users to real-world contacts (rentalscaleup.com).

Host Experience

- Streamlined listing creation for services/experiences (theiskandarian.com).
- Today tab for rapidly managing reservations; improved calendar syncs (theiskandarian.com).

Visual & Interaction Design

- “Lava” icons: lightweight, 3D-like animated symbols offering delight without performance lag (medium.com).
- Color system: dimensional palettes for light/dark theming; new tokens across Luxe and Brand ranges (shubhamanand.in).
- Typography & spacing: enhanced readability and hierarchy via updated tokens (reddit.com).

AI & Personalization

- AI-powered photo tours reordering listing images automatically with a visible “labour illusion” animation (linkedin.com).
- AI recommendations for stays, services, experiences, based on itinerary and profile (techradar.com).

- AI assistant for customer support using natural language .

Results

- Transition toward a super app model cited by leadership and media as Airbnb's strategic evolution ([wired.com](https://www.wired.com)).
- Positive UX signals: fewer friction points across setup, messaging, booking flows (industry feedback, no specific metrics cited).
- Increased trust through verification and connection features .
- Delight boost: UI analyst note that dimensionality and 3D elements counteract flat fatigue .
- Positioned Airbnb for continued usage frequency, beyond occasional travel ([techradar.com](https://www.techradar.com)).

Creative Team Structure

Airbnb Leadership

- Brian Chesky (CEO & Product oversight) – approved every pixel and icon hue .
- VP of Design (Teo Connor) – led UX strategy, host tools & profiles alignment ([wired.com](https://www.wired.com)).
- Product Marketing Head (Jud Coplan) – defined service vision and AI use case integration ([techradar.com](https://www.techradar.com)).

Design & Engineering Teams

- UI Engineering – developed “Lava” icon format and engine ([medium.com](https://www.medium.com)).
- Experience Design Pods – Guests, Hosts, Services dedicated teams.
- Research Group – Extensive interviews and testing across 260 cities & 10,000 vendors ([linkedin.com](https://www.linkedin.com), [wired.com](https://www.wired.com)).
- AI Engineering – Photo tour engine, recommendations, support chatbot.

External Collaborators

- Former Apple designers (Jony Ive, Hiroki Asai) – co-created icon and aesthetic style ([linkedin.com](https://www.linkedin.com/company/apple), [wired.com](https://www.wired.com)).
- Media & PR firms – orchestrated rollout and feature announcements.

Training Utility for Your AI

- Observe design leadership in “founder mode”: hands-on pixel decisions from Chesky ([wsj.com](https://www.wsj.com)).
- Learn how to evolve from product utility to lifestyle ecosystem via UI shifts.
- Model best practices in visual system tokenization: colors, typography, icon formats.
- Combine AI automation with visible UX craft to enhance delight and trust.
- Implement cross-sided product thinking: unified experience for guests, hosts, vendors, and services.